

What is the prognosis?

Last revised in December 2024

- **Without insulin replacement**, people with type 1 diabetes would die within days or weeks.
- **With insulin replacement**, people with type 1 diabetes can participate normally in the usual activities of daily life but are at risk of [complications](/topics/diabetes-type-1/background-information/complications/) (</topics/diabetes-type-1/background-information/complications/>).
 - The risk of complications is greatly reduced by keeping circulating glucose levels to as near normal as possible in order to reduce tissue damage.
 - Disability from complications that are not avoided can often be prevented by early detection and active management.

[[NICE, 2015a \(/topics/diabetes-type-1/references/\)](/topics/diabetes-type-1/references/); [NICE, 2016b \(/topics/diabetes-type-1/references/\)](/topics/diabetes-type-1/references/)]

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